

How to Create and Clone a Repository on GitHub

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Table of Contents

I.	Introduction.....	3
II.	Background	3
III.	Technical Requirements and Cautions.....	3
IV.	Steps	4
1.	Create A GitHub Account	4
2.	Sign Into Your GitHub Account.....	4
3.	Open The Repository Page.....	5
4.	Create The Repository.....	5
5.	Download and Install GitHub Desktop.....	6
6.	Sign Into GitHub Desktop	6
7.	Clone Your Repository with GitHub Desktop	7
V.	Conclusion.....	8

I. Introduction

This guide goes over how to create and clone a repository on GitHub. Anyone Interested will create a GitHub Profile online, create a repository online, download and start using GitHub Desktop, then clone the repository via GitHub Desktop. This guide should be simple enough for anyone who is just beginning to learn how to code. This should likely take no more than 30 minutes to complete in its entirety.

This guide assumes that the audience has not previously used GitHub nor GitHub Desktop on their computer beforehand.

II. Background

GitHub is the most common Version Control Software for code used by software developers. It allows developers to easily store, share, and collaborate on their code online for practically no cost. It is an extremely useful tool for project management as well, as it can be used to track issues inside of code and organize tasks for different team members in a variety of ways.

Code is stored online in repositories, or repos for short. These simply contain files of code where all the sharing and collaboration happens. In fact, repositories have website links created for them as soon as they are born. For example, you can [Click Here](#) to see the repository I made for my own portfolio website.

III. Technical Requirements and Cautions

For this guide, all anyone will need to follow this guide is a laptop or desktop computer (not a phone), a stable internet connection, an email address, and the required permissions on their computer to download and install an application. Furthermore, you must also install a modern web browser such as [Google Chrome](#), as there are multiple websites that you will need to visit.

Please be aware that you will only need to access the domains “github.com”, “desktop.github.com”, and other subdomains of “github.com”. These instructions do not require you to create an account or give your personal data to another website.

IV. Steps

1. Create A GitHub Account

To start, we must create an account on GitHub before we can create GitHub Repository. As shown with Figure 1 to the right, this will ask for your email address, a new password, an official username for the account, and your country of residence. Follow the tasks below.

- Go to <https://github.com/signup> to sign up and create a new account for GitHub.
- Fill in all the necessary fields as instructed by the page.
- Then click “Create Account” at the bottom.

After you click “Create Account”, the GitHub sign-up page will verify your email by sending a code as an email to your email account. Once you have received the code, please enter the code given to you on the text field that is on the sign-up page. This will complete step one.

You can also choose to use your Google Account or Apple Account rather than create an entirely new account with a new password. This, however, is slightly less secure and may cause future complications as you work with GitHub.

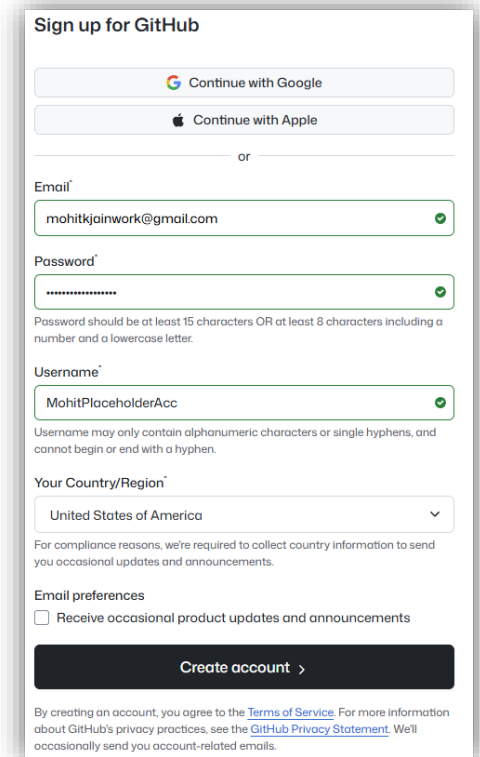


Figure 1: GitHub Sign-Up Page

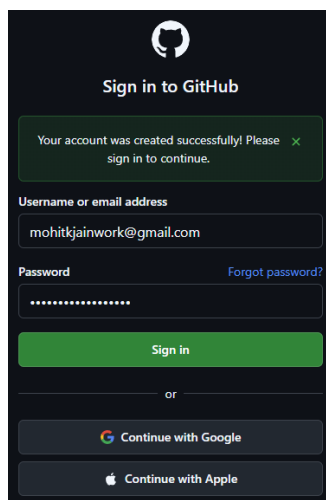


Figure 2: GitHub Sign-In Page

2. Sign Into Your GitHub Account

After creating an account, GitHub will direct you to its sign-in page as shown with Figure 2 on the left.

- Enter your Email or Username to the first field and your password on the next field.
- You can also use your Google or Apple account if you used that to sign up on the previous step.

3. Open The Repository Page

After signing into your account, you should see a page like Figure 3 below on the left. As you can see, it has a top bar with many features and buttons and some tutorial videos. At the very top right on the webpage, you will see your newly created profile icon.

- a) Click on the icon to open a menu of options.
- b) Then click on “Repositories” button to open the Repositories Page.

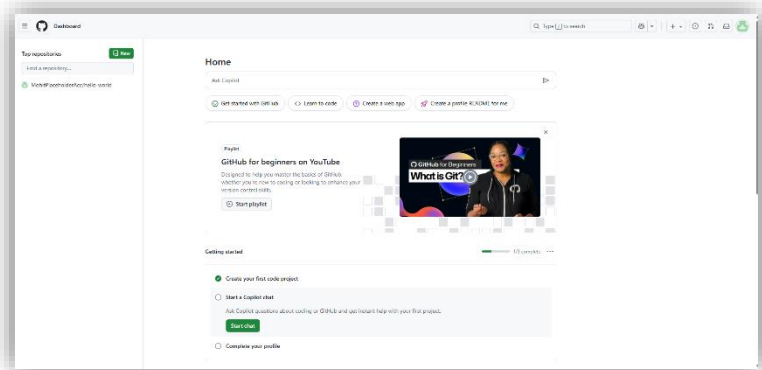


Figure 3: GitHub Home Page

4. Create The Repository

Considering that you just made the account, your repository page will look like it does on Figure 4 to the right, stating that you have not made any repositories yet. If you have made any repositories for your account in the past, they will pop up here. Follow the tasks below:

- a) At the top right, you will see the “New” button. Click on it to open the “Create A Repository” Page as shown with Figure 5 on the right.
- b) Fill in the repository name field with the name to give your repository. Note that this cannot be the same name you gave another repository in the past.
- c) Set “Add README” to “on”. This will make the following steps much easier.
- d) To finish, click the green “Create Repository” button at the bottom right of the webpage.

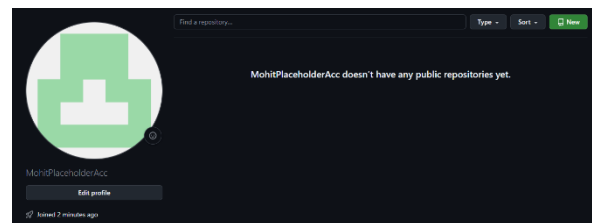


Figure 4: GitHub Repositories Page

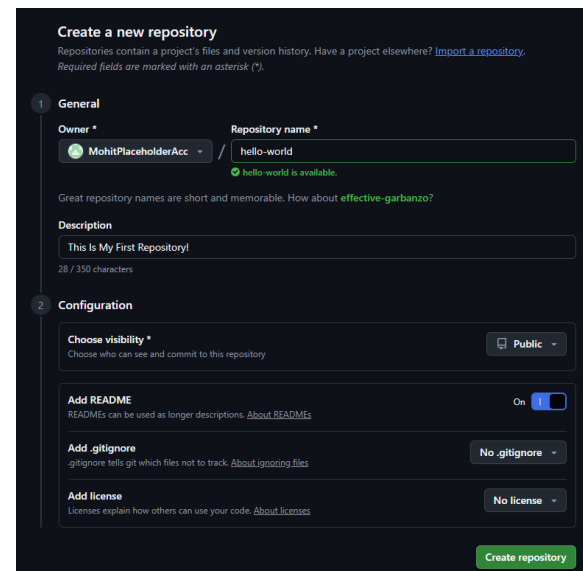


Figure 5: GitHub “Create A Repository” Page

5. Download and Install GitHub Desktop

Now that we have created a repository, we can now clone that repository on our computer. For that, we will use GitHub Desktop, GitHub's very own desktop application. This platform makes using GitHub significantly easier as it makes communication between other desktop applications like Visual Studio Code and the GitHub web platform far easier.

- Go to <https://desktop.github.com/download/> and you'll see a webpage like Figure 7 below.
- Click on "Download for Windows (64bit)" as shown at the center of the webpage.
- If you need to use another downloader, use the options at the bottom of the webpage.
- Open the downloader on your computer and you should eventually see a popup like Figure 8 on the bottom right. Then simply follow the popup's directions until GitHub Desktop is Installed.

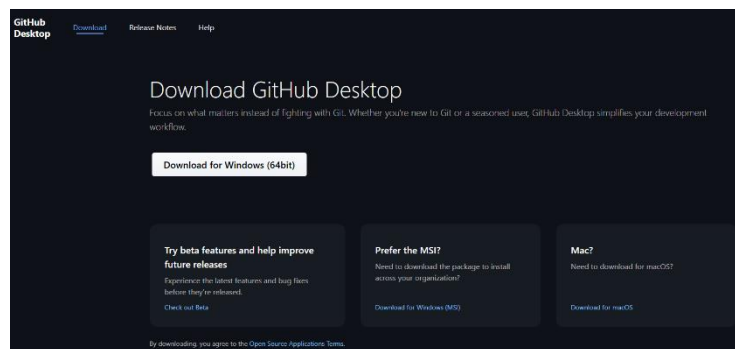


Figure 7: Download GitHub Desktop Page

6. Sign Into GitHub Desktop

After Opening GitHub Desktop, you should see a welcome page like Figure 8 below to the right. However, you must first sign into GitHub Desktop with your GitHub Account.

- Click on the "Sign in to Github.com" button to open the sign in page.
- On the sign-up page on your web browser, choose your GitHub Account that you want to use GitHub Desktop with.
- Then, click on the "Authorize" button on the next page to let GitHub Desktop use your account.

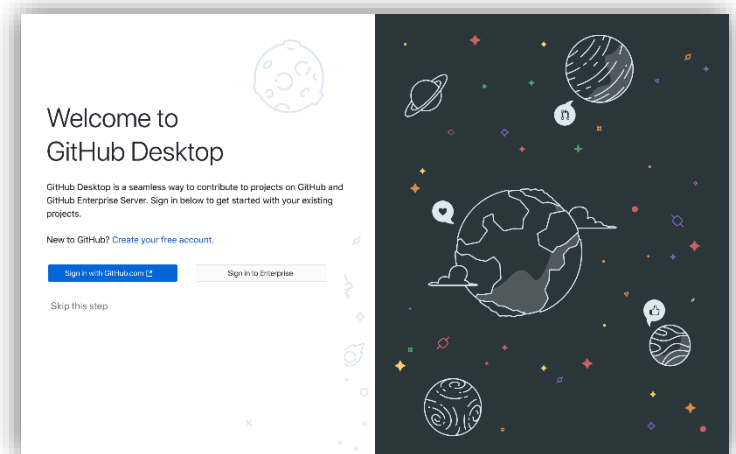


Figure 8: GitHub Desktop Welcome Page

7. Clone Your Repository with GitHub Desktop

To finish, now we can clone the repository easily. There are multiple ways to do this, but we can go back to our repository on github.com.

- a) Open a new tab on your web browser and go to `github.com/[username]/[repo]`. As an example, if my GitHub username is “MohitPlaceholderAcc” and my repository is named “hello-world”, the link for it would be “github.com/MohitPlaceholderAcc/hello-world”.

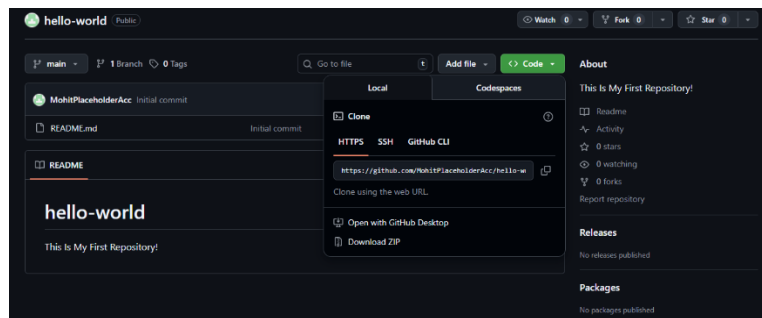


Figure 9: GitHub Repository Details

- b) From there, you should be able to see a page like Figure 9 above. Click on the green “Code” button.
- c) Then a dropdown should open. Click the “Open with GitHub Desktop” button.
- d) This will prompt you to open GitHub Desktop once again. Accept the prompt.

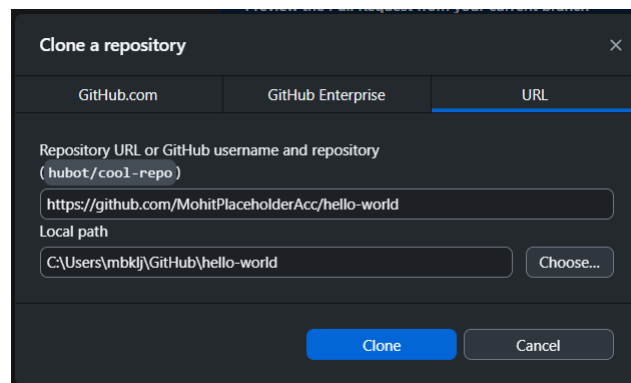


Figure 10: GitHub Clone Menu

- e) When you open GitHub desktop, you’ll see a similar popup to Figure 10 above where a visitor can clone the repository. Click the “Clone” button to complete this step.

V. Conclusion

Now, you have fully completed creating and cloning a repository with GitHub. After this, you'll be able to add, edit, and remove files and folders from repositories of code.

You can use this repository for a coding project you'd like to start off with. Once you have experience working on a team, GitHub will be a very useful resource.

If you have any issues in this guide that aren't addressed here, you can rely on the [GitHub Docs](#) to assist you.